

Floating Fantasy Fortresses

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



With NASA's latest report of an almost guaranteed (<http://bit.ly/1PHa3C8>) three-foot rise in sea levels, houseboats might start sounding pretty good these days. But houseboats have come a long way since the one Tom Hanks' character owns in Sleepless in Seattle (<http://bit.ly/1PHa60H>). Now, if you have the scratch, you can live like a king in your floating fantasy fortress!

A houseboat is a particularly tricky term to lock down. The Travel Channel's Extreme Houseboats (<http://bit.ly/1Ewbvqww>) spotlights a wide range of livable sea-faring crafts. Not all look like a common two story home floating on wooden ballasts. Some look like yachts, some like floating houses, some more recent designs look straight out of a James Bond movie.

The Floating Seahorse

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Floating Seahorse boats, luxury floating homes



This three-story floating home concept is not for the squeamish since the bedroom rests below sea level. So if you are the kind of person who fears things that go bump in the night, you might have trouble resting underwater as ocean life cruises by your bedroom window.

This design also sports a fully furnished kitchen, a glass-bottomed Jacuzzi, and a sun deck, which will come in handy if you decide to float your home in the temperate waters of the Caribbean!

SeaScape Villa

BMT Group, a design firm based in Asia, is making waves with a modular design that boasts the ability to add desired rooms as you wish. BMT's SeaScape press release [reads \(http://bit.ly/1Kn-F7Zt\)](http://bit.ly/1Kn-F7Zt):

"A key feature of SeaScape is a superb underwater bedroom. The 4m-diameter cylindrical room formed from high-grade acrylic can be installed within SeaScape, adding a unique resort experience in a market where the truly different is becoming harder and harder to realize."

Built on a triangular pontoon base, the SeaScape Villa is able to attach rooms of your choosing in the organization that you wish. This concept really shines since each room floats. The idea of adding a room onto a landlocked structure might seem like a headache and can potentially take months. But this floating home is afforded the luxury of merely attaching another free-floating structure, something that would take only a fraction of the time to install.

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Fairview Landing Dock

So you might be asking the question: "Those homes look incredible, but where on Earth would I put that if I bought one?" Well, one such location is up in Seattle at the Fairview Landing Dock.

This dock is billed (<http://2369fairview.com/>) as a "Luxury Floating Homes" destination. This means that you would be in good company and wouldn't be forced to dock your luxury home next to someone else's stinky dingy. Fairview Landing is a tight knit community that shares in the eccentricities of floating mansions. The term houseboat is used endearingly on some of these titans of the sea.

Take this \$2.95 million home (<http://bit.ly/1JsjaCT>), recently listed on Estate.ly. You may quickly forget that you are stepping aboard a floating vessel when you set eyes on this beautiful 2,150 square foot, three-bedroom home. This craftsman-inspired houseboat provides ample room and gives any landlocked residence a run for its money.

The Waternest 100

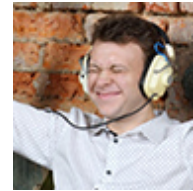


Image Credit: Giancarlo Zema Design Group



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Perhaps you are looking for something a little smaller, maybe an eco-friendly weekend getaway. The Waternest 100 is a svelte 1,076 square feet and boasts a construction made of (<http://bit.ly/1PHaso8>) “recycled laminated-timber and salvaged aluminum hull,” reports designboom.com. The roof can be outfitted with sixty square meters of solar panels, which is reported to be capable of generating a hefty 4 kilowatts of power during peak sunlight.

Designed by Giancarlo Zema Design Group out of Rome, the Waternest 100 offers something truly unique while allowing the owner to live in a structure that remains in harmony with the Earth. No pricing is currently available, but interested parties can contact (<http://bit.ly/1Fc-SsMB>) the design group directly with inquiries.

Takeaway

The practicality and sustainability of houseboats have never been better. Perhaps the future might see an increased adoption of seafaring homes. And with NASA's latest information on the potential sea level rise, those living on the water may end up sleeping soundly as their home sways to the rhythms of the ocean.

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